

Orsolya Oakhurst

Character Dossier

Kind in deeds, sharp in words court astronomer of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Orsolya Oakhurst is a court astronomer living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Orsolya is 78 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around the big top as kind in deeds, sharp in words. In conversation Orsolya swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Background

Orsolya arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 8 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Orsolya describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Orsolya works as a court astronomer near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Orsolya learned the trade from Halcyon Ravensworth, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Orsolya's life is with Benedikt Ironside, over a matter neither will explain. The person Orsolya trusts most is Cassius Nightingale.

Current goal: to find out what happened to the missing caravan. Greatest fear: the far side of the big top.

Personality and speech

Temperament: kind in deeds, sharp in words.

Speech pattern: Orsolya swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Tells: when lying, Orsolya mentions Nutmeg the owl for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Orsolya Oakhurst
Role	court astronomer
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Two Rivers
Age	78
Favourite dish	midnight goat cheese tart
Pet	Nutmeg, a owl

<i>Lucky number</i>	497
<i>Workshop password</i>	birch-lattice
<i>Mentor</i>	Halcyon Ravensworth
<i>Rival</i>	Benedikt Ironside
<i>Closest friend</i>	Cassius Nightingale

Secret

Orsolya once turned down an offer from the Ringmaster's troupe that would have made them rich, and wonders about it nightly.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Orsolya: I am the court astronomer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Orsolya: Midnight goat cheese tart. Do not tell Benedikt I said so.

Visitor: Is Nutmeg yours?

Orsolya: Nutmeg belongs to nobody. Nutmeg tolerates me. Lucky number is 497, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 19

Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the costume tent. Orsolya pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the costume tent. Orsolya pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Orsolya closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Orsolya has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 2, spring of year 19

Orsolya was hired to carry a grain scale from the menagerie wagons to the ticket wagon without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Orsolya read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Orsolya won 33 copper bits on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 3, spring of year 19

Liora came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Orsolya said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the cookfire, Orsolya taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Orsolya was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the cookfire to the ticket wagon without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the cookfire. Orsolya pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 4, summer of year 19

Orsolya won 39 copper bits on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on supper. Orsolya repaired the signal flag at the costume tent for Quillon, who paid in 45 copper bits and a long story about the census. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Orsolya has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 5, winter of year 20

Orsolya won 26 copper bits on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. Orsolya spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 54 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. A stranger asked Orsolya for the password to the workshop. Orsolya laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Orsolya read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 6, winter of year 20

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the quarantine. Orsolya read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Orsolya moved the copper pipe indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. Orsolya found a grain scale half-buried near the cookfire and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Orsolya moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net. The

weather turned. Orsolya moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment.

Entry 7, autumn of year 20

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Orsolya read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Orsolya closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. The weather turned. Orsolya moved the wax seal indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Orsolya read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Orsolya has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 8, autumn of year 20

Orsolya repaired the tin whistle at the menagerie wagons for Juniper, who paid in 63 copper bits and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Tallulah came by asking about the new curfew. Orsolya said nothing useful and made tea instead. Orsolya won 34 copper bits on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 9, summer of year 21

The weather turned. Orsolya moved the sack of salt indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Orsolya repaired the spool of wire at the ticket wagon for Lysander, who paid in 49 copper bits and a long story about the new curfew. Orsolya won 44 copper bits on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on supper. Orsolya was hired to carry a ledger from the ticket wagon to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 10, summer of year 21

At the menagerie wagons, Orsolya taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Orsolya has a suspect and is probably right. At the menagerie wagons, Orsolya taught a newcomer how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. Rosalind came by asking about the quarantine. Orsolya said nothing useful and made tea instead. Orsolya repaired the cracked compass at the menagerie wagons for Quillon, who paid in 87 copper bits and a long story about the harvest count.

Entry 11, winter of year 21

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Orsolya was hired to carry a brass lantern from the menagerie wagons to the cookfire without opening it, and mostly succeeded.